

A Family-Centered Approach to Learning English as a Second Language: A Mixed-Methods Experimental Evaluation

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We present the 2-year experimental mixed-methods findings of a two-generation English as a second language (ESL) program. This program combines a high-dosage, child-oriented curriculum for parents with Head Start for children in addition to family-based supportive services. At baseline and after 2 years, 189 Latinx and Zomi immigrant parents completed surveys while children completed skill assessments. A subset of 67 parents participated in focus groups regarding their experiences. Treatment parents reported significantly higher English writing skills and self-esteem and significantly lower language brokering and material hardship. There were no significant differences in children's outcomes. Possible explanatory mechanisms across multiple contexts were identified in the qualitative data. Evidence is promising that a Two-Generation ESL Program improves some outcomes for parents.

Keywords: early childhood, immigration/immigrants, program evaluation, adult education/development, families

OVER the next 40 years, almost 90% of the United States' population growth is projected to be due to immigrants and their children (Budiman, 2020). Immigrant families are essential to the future of the United States but often

face challenges such as discrimination, cultural adjustment, and language barriers (Carlock, 2016; Waters & Pineau, 2015). For many immigrants to the United States, learning English is a key driver in acculturation, a multidimensional

process that involves merging the values, beliefs, and practices of the heritage- and receiving cultures (Schwartz et al., 2010). One promising strategy for improving the English skills of immigrant families targets parents' and children's learning at the same time.

To target both generations simultaneously, the antipoverty agency Community Action Project of Tulsa (CAP Tulsa) developed the two-generation English as a second language (ESL) Program within their high-quality Head Start program (Sommer et al., 2018). Head Start is the country's largest federally funded early childhood education program and serves around one million young children, approximately one-third of whom speak a language other than English at home (Office of Head Start, 2016). CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program offered child-oriented ESL classes to immigrant parents while their children attended Head Start. The program also provided support to participating families, including coordinated schedules, free childcare, and financial incentives.

After 1 year, we found that the Two-Generation ESL Program demonstrated some initial benefits to Latinx and Asian immigrant families such as higher English reading skills for parents and more engagement with the child's teacher, relative to families in Head Start as usual. However, there were no 1-year effects on child language and cognitive skills (Sommer et al., 2023). The purpose of this experimental mixed-methods study is to increase understanding around two-generation ELS programs by (a) examining whether impacts are sustained, or new effects emerge, for parents and children in CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program after 2 years and (b) exploring possible explanations for these effects in the context of immigrant families' lives. Given the dearth of longitudinal research on family literacy and ESL programs, it is not yet known whether a two-generation approach is effective for improving the longer-term outcomes of immigrant families with limited English proficiency.

Prior Evidence for Adult ESL and Family Literacy Programs

In the United States, ESL programs, which officially became part of federally funded adult

education in 1966, are one avenue for facilitating the acculturation of immigrant adults (McHugh & Doxsee, 2018). ESL instruction has been significantly underfunded, reaching less than 4% of adults in need, and is at serious risk of reduction or elimination during times of economic recession (McHugh & Doxsee, 2018; Park & McHugh, 2014). Many ESL programs are low dosage without attendance requirements and offer limited social or financial support, which can make it more difficult for students to retain new skills (Condelli et al., 2008; Eyring, 2014; Good et al., 2010; McHugh & Doxsee, 2018). Within these programs in the early 2010s, fewer than half advanced their English language skills by one proficiency level (Spurling et al., 2008; U.S. Department of Education, 2015). However, more recent data suggests students in ESL programs are demonstrating better success. For example, 72% of ESL students increased at least one level during the 2020 to 2021 year (National Reporting System for Adult Education, 2022). Condelli et al. (2008) found that specific instructional strategies, including connections to the outside world, improved the language skills of adult ESL students. Likewise, recent programs have taken a more holistic approach to English learning by contextualizing pedagogy to students' interests (e.g., parent involvement and community organizing). Although such approaches are limited, programs that incorporate adult learners' skills, needs, and identities as immigrants demonstrate evidence of English proficiency gains (Carlock, 2016; Waterman, 2009).

CAP Tulsa developed the Two-Generation ESL Program drawing upon elements of adult ESL and family literacy programs. Family literacy programs like Even Start combined adult and early education services for families along with supportive services such as financial incentives and childcare (Cassidy et al., 2004; St. Pierre et al., 2005). Previous research suggests these programs benefit children, parents, and families (Carpentieri, 2012; Swain et al., 2013). In a review of the family literacy research, Carpentieri (2012) noted that parent participants often improved their confidence, relationship with their children's school, knowledge about child development, and parenting skills. Moreover, children in family literacy programs demonstrated improved literacy, language, and

numeracy skills (Carpentieri, 2012). Although related, CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program is somewhat distinctive from past family literacy programs in that the program is based on Head Start. Head Start offers a longstanding early childhood program based on trust, safety, and learning where parents feel comfortable investing in themselves and their children (Chase-Lansdale & Brooks-Gunn, 2014; Sommer et al., 2018). To our knowledge, there are few, if any, randomized control trials of family-centered or two-generation ESL programs in the United States.

Theoretical Background

The current study is primarily informed by the bioecological systems model, which posits that human development is influenced by the interdependence of immediate and distal contexts ranging from person-level to macro-level systems (Bronfenbrenner & Morris, 2006). Recent scholarship has argued that individual development cannot be separated from the larger cultural and social context (Rogers et al., 2021; Vélez-Agosto et al., 2017). We next describe the acculturation process of immigrant families in the United States in relation to the multiple systems of the bioecological model, while remaining cognizant of their inherent connectivity. We begin with the macrosystem, recognizing "cultural ideologies and sociopolitical systems of power as the starting point for understanding human development" (Rogers et al., 2021, p. 276).

Macro-Level Context of Reception

The macrosystem broadly concerns an individual's social environment including the culture that lays the foundation for rules, structures, and activities (Bronfenbrenner & Morris, 2006; Rogers et al., 2021). As a receiving society, the United States currently boasts more newcomers than any other country in the world with dramatic shifts occurring in the past 60 years as more Latinx and Asian people immigrated than ever before (Budiman, 2020). Yet, the United States is a country colonized by mostly English-speaking Europeans on indigenous land and built by enslaved persons from African nations. As a receiving society, the country's complicated

origins reflect its attitudes toward immigrants, referred to as the context of reception, as well as immigrants' options for acculturation (Schwartz et al., 2010). This is indicated in policies affecting immigrant families such as increasingly strict enforcement processes at borders and internally, changing refugee and asylee policies, and policies providing temporary access to employment and schooling for non-citizens such as Deferred Action for Childhood Arrivals (Busch & Yoshikawa, 2022).

Family Processes in the Microsystem

Bronfenbrenner and Morris (2006) defined the microsystem as the pattern of "activities, relationships, and roles" experienced in a given setting (p. 814). Within the family, parent-child interactions are considered one of the most enduring proximal processes that shape development over time. Parents want to be involved in children's learning and immigrant parents often desire to learn English to support their children's development (Sommer et al., 2018; Swain et al., 2013). The dual language practices of immigrant parents can lead to numerous benefits for children (McCabe et al., 2013). But immigrants with limited English proficiency tend to be less educated and more likely to live in poverty than their English-proficient counterparts (Zong & Batalova, 2015). Socioeconomic disadvantage can negatively affect children directly (Brooks-Gunn & Duncan, 1997; Davis-Kean et al., 2021) or indirectly through its harmful effects on parents' mental health and parenting behaviors (Conger et al., 2010). Indeed, English language skills, psychological well-being, parent engagement, and socioeconomic well-being appear connected for immigrant parents in the United States.

At the same time, the relationship between parents and children is not unidirectional. The proximal processes within the microsystem shape family systems through dual development, a scientific framework that focuses on bidirectional influences between parents and children and their linked lives (Sabol et al., 2021). Children from immigrant families are influenced indirectly by their parents' acculturation processes and children's characteristics will likewise influence their parents' acculturation through transactional patterns (Chase-Lansdale et al.,

2007; García Coll et al., 1996). Recognizing that the family is often a source of strength for immigrant parents and children (Cabrera et al., 2021; Carlock, 2016; Chase-Lansdale et al., 2007), programs promoting the educational progress of both generations simultaneously may lead to better developmental outcomes than programs for a single generation alone (Sabol et al., 2021). For instance, parents and children learning English at the same time may lead to increased motivation, skill development, role modeling, and language practice in the home for the entire family.

Person-Level Characteristics

The characteristics of the individual are at the core of the bioecological model (Bronfenbrenner & Morris, 2006). Considering the larger context of the United States as the receiving society, immigrants experience varying acculturative challenges based on personal characteristics such as language, ethnicity, and socioeconomic status, all of which are particularly salient for families in two-generation ESL programs (Schwartz et al., 2010). Schwartz et al. (2010) delineate the diversity of immigrant experiences based on these characteristics: immigrants who reflect the country's dominant culture (e.g., a White, English-speaking doctor from Canada) will likely undergo a smoother acculturation process than less privileged immigrants (e.g., an indigenous farm worker from Mexico). For less privileged immigrants, discrimination from the receiving society communicates messages of inferiority as they are often cast as the "out-group" in the United States (Cabrera et al., 2021; Schwartz et al., 2010). These acculturative stressors can affect the well-being of both the individual and the family and may be passed on to the next generation (Schwartz et al., 2010).

Structural Elements of and Prior Evidence for the Two-Generation ESL Program

CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program offered comprehensive services to immigrant families that spanned multiple contexts. At its core, the program was person-centered with additional family and community elements based in Head Start. Parents were placed in small, tuition-free English classes led by trained and

experienced ESL instructors who were employed by a local public school system. By centering the program in Head Start, all students were parents with young children at CAP Tulsa's early education centers. Unlike most community-based programs, the program was high dosage with classes meeting three times a week for 3 hr at a time for each four-month semester and required consistent attendance (Eyring, 2014; Sommer et al., 2018). Over 2 years, parents were offered four semesters of instruction.

The Two-Generation ESL Program capitalized on the significant relationships and processes within family systems. Designed to support parents' motivation to learn English on behalf of their children, the program used a newly developed curriculum focused on domains of child development to promote English language skills (Sommer et al., 2018). Few ESL programs in the United States tailor their curricula to the specific interests and needs of immigrant parents, namely that many immigrant parents seek to acquire strategies and skills to better support their children's education and development (Sommer et al., 2018). Parents attended English classes at the same time their children were in Head Start and parents received free childcare if they had another child that was too young for Head Start. CAP Tulsa's Head Start programs are high quality with lasting positive outcomes into kindergarten and middle school (Gormley et al., 2008; Phillips et al., 2016). CAP Tulsa encourages a multilingual environment for their young dual language learners and does not discourage parents from speaking in their home language to their children (Sommer et al., 2018).

At the community level, the Two-Generation ESL Program was created and managed by the antipoverty agency CAP Tulsa in Tulsa, Oklahoma. CAP Tulsa recognized the unmet needs of their Head Start families as the city's immigrant population grew. From 2010 to 2015, over one-quarter of Tulsa's population growth was attributed to immigrants, mostly from Central and South America and Myanmar (New American Economy, 2017). In addition to the tuition-free English classes and childcare, parents in the program received financial incentives (e.g., gas cards) for class attendance. Further, all families at CAP Tulsa's Head Start centers had access to their family support specialist, who

helped with crisis management and referrals to community services (Sommer et al., 2018).

Finally, the program provided intensive coaching that addressed these multiple contexts: individual needs, family dynamics, and experiences in the broader community. In addition to the ESL classes, parents met weekly with peer groups led by a coach who encouraged parents' persistence in the program and supported future educational and employment opportunities. The coach reinforced classroom learning from their instructor by modeling home-based parent-child activities such as dialogic reading. The coach was critical in addressing barriers to success by connecting families to necessary resources within and outside of CAP Tulsa. Coaches provided a supportive space for parent peers to discuss complex issues and experiences related to the program, their family, and being an immigrant in the United States.

Previous research on CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program demonstrated promising initial benefits to families. There was high average class attendance for parents offered the program and over 70% of parents completed one 4-month semester (Sommer et al., 2018, 2023). Further, almost three-quarters of parents in the program advanced their English skills by at least one level of proficiency after one semester. After 1 year, parents randomly assigned to the program reported significantly higher English reading skills and engagement of their child's teacher compared to immigrant Head Start parents not in the program. There were no differences in children's language, literacy, or cognitive skills. However, all study children, regardless of parent treatment status, performed similarly to or better than national averages of Head Start children on literacy skills (Sommer et al., 2023). The present study continues this research by examining the experimental effects of the Two-Generation ESL Program on parents and children after 2 years, with a qualitative exploration into the lived experiences of families.

The Current Study

To examine the effects of two-generation ESL programs on families over time, this mixed-methods study considered three research questions:

1. What is the effect of CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program on parents' English language skills, psychological well-being, parent engagement, and socioeconomic well-being after 2 years? Based on the one-year impacts of the program (Sommer et al., 2023), we expected a continuation of the positive effects on parents' English language skills and parent engagement. Further, we anticipated these continued benefits may result in emerging positive effects for parents' psychological well-being as well as socioeconomic well-being after 2 years (Conger et al., 2010).
2. What is the effect of the Two-Generation ESL Program on children's language, emergent literacy, and cognitive skills after 2 years? Although there were null results on child outcomes after 1 year (Sommer et al., 2023), we hypothesized that the influence of parents' improved English, as well as other interrelated outcomes, on children, may take longer. Grounded in the dual developmental framework (Sabol et al., 2021), we hypothesized there may be benefits for children's skills after 2 years as parents continued to learn.
3. What are the person-, micro-, and macro-level contexts that immigrant families experience, and how might these mechanisms explain significant or null effects? We hypothesized that exploring the multi-layered systems of immigrant families would further explain the presence or absence of effects on parent and child outcomes. Further, we expected there to be important contextual experiences that would arise inductively.

Method

Data and Participants

Data on parents and children come from the three-wave Family Advancement Study (FAST). Within CAP Tulsa's Head Start centers, 236 families consented to the program and study. Parents were then assessed on their initial English proficiency using the Basic English Skills Test

(BEST) Plus and placed into beginner, intermediate, or advanced-level groups. Within each group, parents were randomly assigned (2:1 randomization ratio) to receive the Two-Generation ESL Program (treatment $N=149$) or no ESL services (control $N=87$). All children received CAP Tulsa's Head Start program and services regardless of parent treatment status. The first cohort of families began in fall 2014 and the last cohort started in fall 2018. On average, parents completed 1.59 semesters ($SD=1.30$) over a four-semester, 2-year period. Of the 236 families, 189 families (treatment $n=126$, control $n=63$) participated in the study at both baseline (Wave 1) and 2 years after enrollment (Wave 3) for an 80% retention rate.

Parents who participated in the study were mostly mothers (98%), aged 33 years on average, who were married or in a long-term relationship (94%). Most parents immigrated to the United States from Mexico (76%), Myanmar (11%), and other countries in Central and South America (13%). Around 18% of the sample were recent immigrants, moving to the United States within 5 years of starting the program. On average, children were 4 years old at baseline and most children in the sample were Latinx (88%). Most of the children in the study had aged out of CAP Tulsa's Head Start centers after 2 years (77%). See Table 1 for additional sample descriptives.

Procedures

Data sources included: parent surveys (in person or over the phone, at baseline and after 1 and 2 years), child direct assessments (at CAP Tulsa or home, at baseline and after 1 and 2 years), and parent focus groups (at CAP Tulsa or Oklahoma State University–Tulsa, variable depending on the timing of the focus groups). Surveys, assessments, and focus groups were conducted in the participants' preferred language. Nine treatment ($n=51$ parents) and three control ($n=16$ parents) focus groups took place in the fall of 2014, 2015, and 2016 with trained bilingual staff. Interested parents were placed into focus groups based on their initial level of English proficiency (e.g., beginner, intermediate/advanced) and their home language (e.g., Spanish or Zomi). Ten of the

focus groups were conducted in Spanish and two in Zomi. Parents were offered a \$40 gift card for participating in either the survey or the focus groups and received an additional \$15 for their child's participation in the assessments. The study protocol and procedures were approved by Northwestern University's Institutional Review Board #STU00086217.

Measures: Quantitative

Parent Outcomes. Parents responded to survey questions across multiple domains—English language skills, psychological well-being, parent engagement, and socioeconomic well-being—using validated measures. Although not without limitations, self-report measures provide nuanced and valuable tools to assess cognitive, psychological, and behavioral outcomes through participant's own perceptions and insights (Pekrun, 2020), including their opinions of their English proficiency.

English Language Skills. Parents reported their own perceptions of their English speaking, reading, and writing skills by answering "How well do you {speak/read/write} English?" on a scale from 1 = *not at all* to 4 = *very well*.

Psychological Well-being. Parents were asked about their psychological well-being across three measures. Parents indicated their level of parenting stress using four items from the Aggravation in Parenting Questionnaire (averaged, $\alpha=.70-.71$ over Waves 1–3; CRCW, 2013). Parents completed six questions on their psychological distress using the Kessler 6 scale (averaged, $\alpha=.80-.84$; Kessler et al., 2002). Parents also rated their self-esteem using four items from the Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale (average, $\alpha=.74-.87$; Rosenberg, 1989).

Parent Engagement. Parents answered questions across three scales related to parent engagement. Parents reported on parenting abilities using the 6-item Alabama Positive Parenting Questionnaire (averaged, $\alpha=.70-.74$; Frick, 1991). Parents responded to four items regarding their engagement with their child's teacher (e.g., "How often did you talk to the teacher about

TABLE 1

Baseline Sample Descriptives for Parents and Children in the Analytic Samples

Variable	N=189
Parent	
Age in years, <i>M</i> (<i>SD</i>)	33.05 (5.04)
Female %	98.41
Married or partnered %	93.62
Latinx %	89.42
Country of origin %	
Mexico	76.06
Myanmar	10.64
Other	13.30
Recent immigrant %	17.99
Education %	
Less than high school	41.18
High school/GED	44.39
Certificate/AA/BA or higher	14.44
Household income, <i>M</i> (<i>SD</i>)	22,239.77 (8,727.47)
Household size, <i>M</i> (<i>SD</i>)	4.97 (1.32)
Child	
Age in years, <i>M</i> (<i>SD</i>)	3.78 (1.25)
Female %	41.27
Latinx %	87.83
Language parent speaks with child %	
English	1.59
Spanish	76.72
Zomi	10.58
English and Spanish	11.11

Note. Analytic sample includes families with data at baseline (Wave 1) and 2 years after baseline (Wave 3).

your education/training?" averaged, $\alpha = .58-.63$). Parents then answered two questions on how frequently their child translated when parents communicated with other adults and when parents communicated with the child's teacher or principal (averaged, $\alpha = .66-.74$).

Socioeconomic Well-being. Parents reported their socioeconomic well-being on three indicators. Parents were asked if they had received their high school diploma or GED (1 = *yes*). Similarly, parents reported if they were currently employed (1 = *yes*). Parents also completed questions on material hardship using eight items (averaged, $\alpha = .70-.71$; Yoshikawa et al., 2008).

Child Outcomes. Children were assessed on four language, literacy, and cognitive assessments.

Language and Emergent Literacy Skills. Children's total acquired vocabulary was tested using the Expressive One-Word Picture Vocabulary Test: Spanish-Bilingual Edition (EOWPVT: SBE). The EOWPVT: SBE is a norm-referenced test of single-word picture naming that was administered to Spanish-speaking children only (i.e., Zomi-speaking children did not complete this test). Raw scores were converted to standardized scores ($M = 100$, $SD = 15$). Next, the Pre-IDEA Proficiency Test (Pre-IPT) measured a child's proficiency in the English language through assessment of vocabulary, grammar, comprehension, and verbal expression (Ballard & Tighe, Publishers, 2010). The test increased in difficulty until the test was complete or they reached their proficiency ceiling, at which the examiner noted the number of errors. Scores align with proficiency levels ranging from A (1) to E (5) with E representing advanced proficiency. The Woodcock-Johnson-III Tests of Achievement, Letter-Word Identification subtest measured children's reading decoding through the sight recognition of letters and words with increasing difficulty (Mather & Woodcock, 2001). Raw scores were converted to standardized scores ($M = 100$, $SD = 15$).

Cognitive Skills (Working Memory). The Memory for Digit Span assessment measured children's short-term memory as children listened to and repeated a sequence of numbers, which increased in length (Wechsler, 1974). Each correct response was worth one point.

Measures: Qualitative

Parents were asked questions in their home language by a trained interviewer. Questions for parents in both the treatment and control groups focused on parents' experiences with current and past ESL programs, including CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program and its specific components (e.g., instructor, coach, peers, and incentives) if the parent was in the program. Parents were then asked about their future educational and career goals and how they balanced school, work, and life with young children. Lastly, parents answered questions about their child's Head Start classroom and teacher in addition to CAP Tulsa's staff and services.

To understand the impact of the Two-Generation ESL Program on families, we used intent-to-treat (ITT) and treatment-on-the-treated (TOT) approaches to estimate parent survey and child direct assessment outcomes. The ITT approach is a policy-relevant analysis (Gupta, 2011) that compares families according to whether they were offered treatment (i.e., access to the Two-Generation ESL Program). The TOT approach, however, considers whether participants complied with their randomization assignment. All parents randomly assigned to the control group were compliant with their assignment and did not participate in the Two-Generation ESL Program during the FAST study period. On the other hand, 39 of the 149 parents assigned to treatment (26%) did not comply by not participating in at least one semester. To address this issue of imperfect compliance, the TOT approach estimates the local average treatment effect on families who were randomly assigned to the treatment group and actually participated in the Two-Generation ESL Program to those who were randomly assigned to the control group and did not participate in the program.

Using the ITT and TOT approaches, we conducted a series of linear regressions to determine whether participation in the Two-Generation ESL Program ($1 = \text{treatment}$, $0 = \text{control}$) significantly predicted parent and child outcomes. Covariates for the parent models included: parent sex, age, ethnicity, baseline outcome, English proficiency track, and semester and year of program entry. Covariates for the child models included: child sex, age, ethnicity, and baseline outcome, as well as parent English proficiency track and semester and year of program entry. All parent and child measures were standardized so coefficient estimates can be interpreted as effect sizes in standard deviation units.

Parent variable missingness ranged from 0% to 35% (positive parenting skills at Wave 1). Child variable missingness ranged from 0% to 44% (letter-word skills at Wave 1). Missing baseline covariate variables were imputed using multiple imputations with chained equations in Stata 15.1 (StataCorp, College Station, TX) to create 40 datasets. Outcome variables were not imputed so sample sizes differ across outcomes.

Analysis of the parent focus groups involved a multi-step flexible coding process (Deterding & Waters, 2021). First, each of the 12 focus groups was translated from either Spanish or Zomi to English by a trained translator. The two lead authors of the study read and reviewed the transcripts and created summaries based on predetermined and emerging topics leading to the development of a coding scheme. Next, the lead author and two trained undergraduate research assistants applied the coding scheme to each transcript using the Dedoose software, discussing and reviewing codes together as a means of checking each other's work. Results were then analyzed and synthesized by the two first authors.

The qualitative research team first used a deductive approach to coding the treatment and control focus groups based on the Two-Generation ESL Program's requirements and goals for both parents and children: motivation to learn English; changes in English skills, psychological well-being, parent engagement, and family dynamics, and education and employment; benefits and drawbacks of the program including comparisons to previous community-based ESL programs (treatment) or general experiences in other ESL programs (control); changes in child's well-being and experiences with specific elements of CAP Tulsa's Head Start family programming. After initial coding, the research team applied an inductive approach to the focus groups and developed an additional code that was salient to families in both the treatment and control groups: issues related to discrimination, racism, language, and cultural barriers.

Results

Experimental Program Effects on Parents After 2 Years

We conducted linear regressions to examine the first research question focused on the 2-year impacts of the Two-Generation ESL Program on the outcomes of parents over four domains (see Table 2 for results from the ITT and TOT analyses). One-year results from Sommer et al. (2023) are reproduced in Table 2 to facilitate interpretation. Only results from the ITT analyses are described in text as results from the TOT

TABLE 2

One- and Two-Year Effects of the Two-Generation ESL Program on Parent's English Language Skills, Parent Engagement, Psychological Well-Being, and Socioeconomic Well-Being.

Parent outcomes	1-Year impacts			2-Year impacts		
	<i>N</i>	ITT	TOT	<i>N</i>	ITT	TOT
English language skills						
Speaking	192	0.07 (0.14)	0.08 (0.15)	187	0.09 (0.14)	0.11 (0.17)
Reading	192	0.31 (0.14)*	0.36 (0.15)*	187	0.16 (0.14)	0.19 (0.16)
Writing	192	0.27 (0.14) [†]	0.31 (0.16)*	187	0.36 (0.14)**	0.43 (0.16)**
Parent-child engagement						
Positive parenting skills	168	0.07 (0.15)	0.08 (0.18)	165	−0.08 (0.16)	−0.10 (0.18)
Teacher/school-based support	171	0.44 (0.15)**	0.51 (0.16)**	151	−0.06 (0.16)	−0.07 (0.17)
Child language brokering	196	−0.20 (0.15)	−0.23 (0.17)	189	−0.29 (0.14)*	−0.34 (0.17)*
Psychological well-being						
Parenting stress	184	0.05 (0.14)	0.06 (0.15)	181	−0.02 (0.15)	−0.02 (0.17)
Psychological distress	197	0.02 (0.14)	0.03 (0.16)	189	0.04 (0.14)	0.05 (0.16)
Self-esteem	195	0.16 (0.15)	0.19 (0.17)	187	0.26 (0.15) [†]	0.31 (0.18) [†]
Socioeconomic well-being						
HS diploma or GED	194	−0.02 (0.12)	−0.02 (0.14)	173	0.06 (0.13)	0.08 (0.14)
Employed	197	−0.07 (0.14)	−0.08 (0.16)	189	−0.02 (0.15)	−0.02 (0.17)
Material hardship	180	−0.13 (0.12)	−0.15 (0.14)	176	−0.31 (0.13)*	−0.36 (0.15)*

Note. Most of the 1-year impacts presented in this table were previously presented in Sommer et al. (2023). The 1-year outcomes were based on an imputation model with fewer variables and therefore do not perfectly replicate previous findings although results are qualitatively the same. The 1-year effects on child language brokering and parent education, employment, and material hardship were not examined in Sommer et al. (2023) but are included here to facilitate the interpretation of effects over time. The ITT column presents the differences in parents' outcomes based on whether parents were offered the Two-Generation ESL Program. The TOT column presents the differences in parents' outcomes using random assignment as an instrument for participation in the Two-Generation ESL Program. Analyses controlled for parent's sex, age, race/ethnicity, English proficiency track, semester and year of entry into the program, and baseline outcome (except for frequency of child translation which was not collected in Wave 1). All values can be interpreted as effect sizes as outcomes were standardized. ESL = English as a second language; ITT = intent-to-treat; TOT = treatment-on-the-treated.

[†] $p < .10$. * $p < .05$. ** $p < .01$. *** $p < .001$.

analyses follow similar patterns but with estimates that are larger in magnitude.

In terms of English language skills, the initial 1-year positive effect on writing skills was sustained and demonstrated an increase in magnitude after 2 years ($B = 0.36$, $SE = 0.14$, $p = .009$). The effect on reading skills was not sustained over time and there were no differences between treatment and control parents on speaking skills in the second year. There were null effects on two psychological well-being measures—parenting stress and psychological distress—after 2 years of participation in the Two-Generation ESL Program. Treatment parents reported marginally significantly higher self-esteem after 2 years compared to parents in the control group ($B = 0.26$, $SE = 0.15$, $p = .087$). Regarding parent engagement, the initial positive effect on engagement with the child's teacher was not sustained

after 2 years. Parents reported that their child engaged in less language brokering ($B = -0.29$, $SE = 0.14$, $p = .049$) after the second year. There was no significant effect on positive parenting skills. There were no significant effects on socioeconomic well-being regarding parent education and employment, although parents in the treatment group reported less material hardship after 2 years ($B = -0.31$, $SE = 0.13$, $p = .020$).

*Experimental Program Effects on Children
After 2 Years*

Similar to the parent outcome models, we conducted linear regressions to examine the second research question on the 2-year impacts of parents' participation in the Two-Generation ESL Program on the outcomes of children across two domains (see Table 3). After 2 years, children

TABLE 3

One- and Two-Effects of the Two-Generation ESL Program on Children’s Language and Cognitive Skills.

Child outcomes	1-Year impacts			2-Year impacts		
	<i>N</i>	ITT	TOT	<i>N</i>	ITT	TOT
Language skills						
Vocabulary	150	−0.01 (0.13)	−0.02 (0.14)	115	−0.09 (0.19)	−0.10 (0.21)
English proficiency	114	0.03 (0.16)	0.04 (0.17)	108	0.13 (0.18)	0.15 (0.19)
Cognitive skills						
Letter-word skills	145	0.04 (0.17)	0.04 (0.19)	114	0.14 (0.20)	0.17 (0.22)
Memory	117	0.13 (0.14)	0.15 (0.15)	74	0.23 (0.18)	0.26 (0.19)

Note. The 1-year impacts presented in this table were previously presented in Sommer et al. (2023). The ITT column presents the differences in children’s outcomes based on whether parents were offered the Two-Generation ESL Program. The TOT column presents the differences in children’s outcomes using random assignment as an instrument for parent participation in the Two-Generation ESL Program. Analyses controlled for child’s sex, age, race/ethnicity, baseline outcome, and parent’s English proficiency track and semester and year of entry into the program. All values can be interpreted as effect sizes as outcomes were standardized. ESL = English as a second language; ITT = intent-to-treat; TOT = treatment-on-the-treated.

[†]*p* < .10. **p* < .05. ***p* < .01. ****p* < .001.

with parents who were offered the program did not significantly differ in vocabulary, English proficiency, letter-word skills, or working memory from children whose parents were not offered the program.

Understanding Program Effects Through Context

In line with the third research question, focus groups with parents in both treatment and control groups identified possible mechanisms for program effects that were situated within multiple systems of context, such as macro-, micro-, and person-levels (Bronfenbrenner & Morris, 2006). We first explored the positive and negative macro-level cultural, societal, and community contexts of all study families (i.e., the full sample) living in Tulsa and the United States. We then used this broader context to frame the added benefit of receiving access to the Two-Generation ESL Program for families in the treatment group. Likewise, we examined the experiences of families in the control group who were motivated to improve their English proficiency but did not receive access to the program. Although similar themes were found in both the Spanish and Zomi focus groups, most examples and quotes come from Spanish-speaking parents.

Given the inductive and deductive nature of the analysis, we note that the survey and

assessment measures and outcomes for parents and children do not necessarily align with the thoughts and feelings parents shared in the focus groups. Quantitative surveys have numerous benefits such as ease of administration, which increases sample size. However, these survey measures are blunt instruments that may not fully capture changes in participants or provide information on the mechanisms behind the effects. Further, qualitative focus groups may help elucidate quantitative findings by drawing connections among outcomes. Immigrant families lead complex lives and, together, quantitative and qualitative results can help explain their experiences in two-generation ESL programs while amplifying their voices.

Full Sample

Discrimination Characterizes the Context of Reception of the United States. In most of the treatment and control focus groups, parents reported on the unwelcoming reception toward immigrants in the United States. At the structural level, parents discussed the country’s national leadership and policies and their subsequent fears surrounding deportation. For instance, one focus group discussed rumors they would be sent back to Mexico by then-President Trump. Some parents reported feeling neglected by American society as immigrants and asked, “How are we

going to emerge in a better society if we are going to stay [at the bottom] and nobody is going to give us work?" Many parents emphasized how personal characteristics, such as their ethnicity, were weaponized as the basis for discrimination in more proximal interactions. One mother described being detained for hours at the airport because she was Latina while another shared its effects on her psychological well-being, "I even suffered an unbearable depression, an unbearable stress because [my boss] discriminated against me."

Although parents hoped their children would not experience discrimination—"May it not happen to [the children] the same thing that is happening to us, the discrimination with those who speak in Spanish and who speak in English"—they acknowledged it had already begun. Parents noted numerous discriminatory acts occurring at their children's school (outside of CAP Tulsa) as one mother explained, "When my daughter started kindergarten, my heart also broke from the moment I left her because I saw that the teacher was very racist."

Support and Belonging Through the Head Start Community. Although the broader social environment was largely unreceptive to immigrants, families in the treatment and control groups found safety and belonging in CAP Tulsa's Head Start community. Every parent and child in the study was part of the agency's family programming, which included high-quality Head Start services for children and access to the organization's other resources. Parents in both groups reported high satisfaction in their experience with the Head Start program, which helped alleviate their worries: "It is a great opportunity and peace of mind that we have [the children] here at CAP Tulsa." Parents in the control group described their child's development after enrolling at CAP Tulsa: "My child already knows how to write his name" and "the children already acquire a routine at school, then one practices with them at home." Parents were cognizant of the effects an early education environment could have on their child's future: "The CAP program prepares them [. . .] so that when they enter kindergarten, they already know what they are going to learn in that year. That was what made me put her in from an early age." As members of the

CAP Tulsa community, all parents had access to the agency's family support specialist who connected them to community partners and resources to help fulfill their needs. Further, almost all parents across the treatment and control groups reported participating in CAP Tulsa's "Incredible Years" and "Abriendo Puertos/Opening Doors" programs, which are evidence-based programs designed to promote positive parenting skills and parenting stress management (Moore et al., 2014; Pidano & Allen, 2015).

Treatment Group

Two-Generation ESL Program's Family-Focused Elements. Parents in the treatment uniquely received access to the Two-Generation ESL Program, which was built on the sense of belonging and trust cultivated by CAP Tulsa's Head Start program. One parent described the Two-Generation ESL Program as "an apprenticeship for the whole family." Parents in the program noted how the coordination of their ESL classes with their child's Head Start schedule led to greater attendance and punctuality on their part: "I can go to these classes with my children and be punctual." The ESL program also offered enrolled parents co-located childcare for children too young for CAP Tulsa's Head Start program, which parents described as essential to their educational success: "I like it because I can organize myself at school with my daughters, the house, and then they offered the nursery school for the baby so I don't have to battle much." Treatment parents also reflected on the applicability of the ESL curriculum to their daily lives, with an emphasis on their child's school environment:

What I also liked about the classes at CAP is that they teach you about your day-to-day life, like when they taught us how to talk with our children's teacher. [. . .] I mean, they teach us things that are useful and interesting for us.

Parents in the treatment group also explained how the combination of the free tuition and childcare and incentives (e.g., gas cards) were critical to their success and reduced their financial burden as one mother described: "More than anything, they are paying for daycare and our class, yes, to the entire program in general." Some parents noted that they would not be able

to attend class regularly without the gas cards for transportation expenses, which was often worrisome: "It is one less expense for us in our pocket [. . .] I don't worry about having \$10 for gas anymore."

Parents also discussed three interpersonal program elements that facilitated their success: peers, instructors, and coaches. For parents, a small cohort of peers with common interests (i.e., almost all mothers of young children in CAP Tulsa's Head Start program) led to a sense of connection, safety, and trust. When discussing their bonds of respectful and supportive friendship, one mother noted the sense of equality in their connection, "The harmony in the group has also counted a lot, because until now no one feels [better] than anyone else, and we all help each other." Another parent specifically commented on how the group's gender affinity and trust led to her steady participation: "Since here there are only women, I liked this group. I never stopped coming [. . .] we all trust each other."

According to parents, a mix of attributes of their ESL instructors contributed to their success in the program. Parents reported that the instructors were patient, accessible, and volunteered to stay after class to answer questions, which rarely occurred in their previous experiences with community-based ESL programs. Instructors treated their students with respect and dignity, as one parent described, "She makes us feel important, because she is there even for the smallest [details]." The instructors' nurturing qualities were paired with demandingness and high expectations as parents explained that the instructors were strict, emphasizing daily practice and providing homework. Due to the program's attendance requirements, students showed up regularly, giving instructors the opportunity to assess the abilities of each student, which helped the class progress: "My colleagues are constantly punctual, and the teacher knows the progress each one has made, unlike in the other classes. She is demanding, but it's for our own good!"

Parents described the benefits of meeting weekly with their coach and small group of peers, which was occasionally attended by their ESL instructor. Parents noted the high levels of communication between their instructor and coach, as the meetings were designed to reinforce their

classroom learnings: "[Coach] talks to us and the teacher is over there listening because the teacher tells her what we've seen that week, so she wants us to practice what we learn that week when we are with [Coach]." Together, the students, instructors, and coaches appeared to create a positive environment that led parents to feel a strong sense of community.

Instructors Fostered a Positive Environment That Was Not Mirrored Outside the Classroom. Within the program, teachers and coaches facilitated a sense of community and connectedness among parents to foster their growth in English proficiency. Parents were particularly nervous about practicing their English-speaking skills, but their instructors' encouragement led to an increased sense of confidence: "She supports us emotionally because she tells us we can do it, just try to do it because you can." Parents noted how this positive classroom environment, which did not exist in their previous experiences with other ESL programs, motivated them to practice, "We trust our group, we are not afraid of talking" and "we respect other people when they talk, we respect others."

But parents often did not feel this level of respect once they left the classroom, especially when practicing their English-speaking abilities. Many parents reported that those they interacted with pretended they could not understand what the parents were saying:

Sometimes I have a bad experience when you're going to pay and you try saying something, and you know you are saying it correctly and they say: "Huh, huh?" as if they don't understand [. . .] he pretended he did not understand what I was saying.

Many parents were embarrassed by these negative interactions as one mother described her fear, "You are scared of talking because you think the rest will criticize or make fun of you [. . .] sadly that is why sometimes we do not talk, because lots of people make fun of us." Contrarily, other parents took these experiences as motivation to persist in learning English: "It is just another reason for not wasting the opportunity to learn [. . .] there are people who want to humiliate you, so to speak, and it makes you want to learn even more."

Building Confidence With New Skills: "Not Only Did Our Language Change, Our Mind Changed As Well." All nine of the treatment focus groups discussed increases in confidence due to their new English abilities and six groups mentioned reductions in fear. For example, one parent said, "The language is what gives us a little more confidence [and] I say, 'Nothing is going to happen to me'" as another noted, "[The] fear is removed from me, because the truth is before it was very painful, very scary to speak and not now." With less fear, treatment parents discussed how a sense of improved English proficiency in their everyday lives led to more interaction outside of the home: "For school, if the mechanic damages your car, the doctor, at the supermarket, everything." Some parents became so confident in themselves and their abilities that they began to help other members of their family or community. This often occurs in critical situations such as with the healthcare or legal systems. For instance, one mother explained, "I was with my sister-in-law during her delivery, without a translator. Just with her doctor, and I was her translator!"

English Skills and Confidence Related to Positive Parent Engagement. Parents in the program noted that positive feelings of self-esteem and confidence impacted their roles as familial caregivers. One mother explained, "I'm the one who always has to take the kids to the dentist's appointment, the doctor's appointment, everything, the parent-teacher conference, everything. And now I feel more confident." As it was central to the program's child-oriented curriculum, many treatment parents commented on their improved relationship with their child's teacher. For example, one parent said, "Since I have been taking English lessons, now I feel more confident to know what to ask teachers and understand them." Other parents took these interactions as opportunities to practice speaking English: "I ask [child's teacher] about my child and she tells me, so it is really helping me speak [and] I'm practicing with my child's teacher."

Parents' improved English skills and confidence, coupled with dialogic reading modeled by their coach, led to more interaction with their children at home around learning:

[Coach] also helped us to communicate better with our children when we have to read them a story, how we can interact with them to ask them questions about the book, which I had never done before [. . .] [Coach] gave us another book to read to our children and they taught how to gesture while we were reading the book so that children got excited.

Another parent described how the program improved their knowledge of child development, "It also helped me to read with my kid who was very little [. . .] you can see how important it really is to spend time and look at the pictures, explain things calmly, with patience."

Intergenerational Role Modeling and Skill Development. Unprompted, parents in two-thirds of the treatment focus groups recognized the simultaneous positive change occurring in themselves and their children. First, treatment parents noted their children seemed excited that they shared learning experiences with their parents: "[The children] are happy because I say, 'You're not the only one going to school now, I am also going to school.'" As they progressed in the program, parents felt like they were becoming role models for their children, serving as a positive example for the younger generation to work toward achieving their educational goals. At the same time, parents recognized how much they were learning from their child. For instance, one mother said, "One learns from children, they go to school to learn, right? But one learns from them also, and one practices what one learned at school with them."

Looking to the other generation for inspiration and support appeared to promote the concurrent skill development of parents and children. For example, one mother described the dynamic interplay between both generations around homework, "Sometimes my daughter would help with my homework. I help her but she also helps me." One mother commented on her family's simultaneous growth around reading, "And right now every time we go to sleep, my girl, 'Mommy, let's read a book,' and there we are both reading. In other words, we are learning both at the same pace." Overall, many parents recognized how their participation in the Two-Generation ESL Program at the same time as their child's participation in CAP Tulsa's Head Start program

simultaneously promoted the development of both generations: “CAP for me has been a university for my children and for me.”

With Support, Confidence, and Skills, Parents Focused on Their Own Well-being. In feeling secure in their children’s developmental progress and well-being at CAP Tulsa, as well as confident in their own English abilities and parenting skills, parents in the treatment group expressed an interest in their own future goals. Parents explained “many new doors are open” due to their increasing English proficiency as program coaches helped the parents focus their ambitions and build confidence. This mother described the effects of her coach’s attention and encouragement:

[Coach] could see I could, that I had the skills to do this or the other. It had been a long time since someone had spoken to me like that. It helped me a lot. [. . .] It is very nice how they focus on you and how you can outdo yourself.

Control Group

Mixed Experiences With “Business-As-Usual” Conditions for ESL. Within the macro-level contexts of broader society and CAP Tulsa, families in the control group navigated “business-as-usual” conditions in their pursuit to learn English. Many parents were currently or previously enrolled in community-based ESL programs and parents discussed the benefits and challenges of these programs. Overall, most parents felt their ESL instructors were helpful and motivating, noting their patience and “that they make an effort to put up with us.” Due to the lack of attendance requirements, parents observed that many of their classmates did not consistently attend. Even so, parents felt they were learning incrementally and increasing their confidence. Unlike the treatment group, however, parents in the control group did not explicitly discuss the connection between their own learning and their young child’s educational experiences. Parents in the control group also mentioned difficulty in coordinating their ESL class schedules with work and childcare. For example, one mother had to drop out of an ESL program because it did not provide childcare. Lastly, almost all parents struggled financially and explained it was challenging to afford

the classes and materials, which could be as high as \$200 per year.

Discussion

Acquiring or improving English language skills is one pathway to supporting the acculturation process of immigrant families in the United States. Many immigrant parents want to learn English to better support themselves and their children as they merge their heritage and receiving cultures (Park & McHugh, 2014; Sommer et al., 2018; Swain et al., 2013). This longitudinal mixed-methods study offers encouraging results for the field of two-generation ESL programs by pairing adult ESL services with children’s Head Start and family-based supports. Although there were no significant effects on children’s outcomes, we found that parents who were randomly assigned to CAP Tulsa’s Two-Generation ESL Program reported higher English writing skills and self-esteem, as well as less language brokering and material hardship, than parents who were not offered the program. Focus groups with parents identified the complex, interdependent contextual factors that are critical to immigrant parents’ acculturation and success in learning a new language. Next, the quantitative and qualitative findings are discussed in tandem to provide a holistic view of families’ experiences, although we acknowledge there is not perfect alignment across data sources.

The Two-Generation ESL Program Strengthened Interrelated Outcomes for Parents

Advancements in English proficiency among treatment parents appeared related to wider benefits of learning, particularly increased self-esteem and confidence. Similar to prior research on family literacy programs (Carpentieri, 2012; Swain et al., 2013), this enhanced sense of self may be related to other facets of life such as engaging more with their children’s learning at home and school. Alternatively, increased parent-child engagement may boost parents’ own psychological well-being as they learn along with their child. Improved English language proficiency, self-esteem and confidence, and parental engagement may just be the right combination of skills and well-being that may make it possible

for parents in two-generation ESL programs to progress toward their own goals.

Parents' success was also potentially promoted through key program elements such as family-based services as well as the qualities of coaches, instructors, and peers. Free tuition and childcare, along with financial incentives like gas cards, seemed to increase parents' ability to participate in the Two-Generation ESL Program by reducing some barriers and stressors. The fact that the curriculum and coaching strategies were contextualized to child development may be a key reason why the program led to more engagement among parents, children, and the child's teacher. Lastly, peers and ESL instructors created a safe space for learning and practicing new skills. In addition, the program's attendance requirements and the instructor's ability to convey support along with demandingness also likely led to positive outcomes. Parents in the control group who participated in community-based ESL programs reported some positive experiences with their instructors and their learning process. Yet, there were several quantitative differences between the treatment and control groups, suggesting the additional component of ESL services for adults has a unique and positive effect on parents compared to Head Start's already comprehensive services.

Opportunities for Growth by Addressing the Macro-Level Contexts of Immigrant Families

Findings from this mixed-method study also revealed some areas of improvement for this specific Two-Generation ESL Program, as well as the broader field, with the experiences of immigrant families providing important context. Program parents reported increased English reading and writing proficiency over time but did not improve their speaking skills. Parents may rate themselves lower on this specific skill due to conflicting reactions in their various social environments. Interpersonal acts of discrimination outside of the classroom, driven by macro-level cultural ideologies and social systems such as racism, xenophobia, and anti-immigrant policies, often inhibited parents' willingness to practice speaking in English and decreased their confidence in their abilities (Carlock, 2016; Rogers et al., 2021). CAP Tulsa, and other providers of

ESL services or two-generation programs, cannot control broader cultural and public attitudes but should consider a more explicit approach to addressing the realities and consequences of discrimination and racism with immigrant parents. One approach may be to provide additional safe opportunities for speaking in and out of the classroom, such as field trips with instructors or coaches to restaurants, libraries, or stores in the community. Another may be to combine training in community organizing and civic action, similar to an ESL initiative for immigrant parents in Massachusetts (Carlock, 2016).

Program parents also reported that their young children of parents translated less compared to children of control parents. The literature on the effects of language brokering on immigrant families demonstrates mixed results including higher academic self-efficacy (Buriel et al., 1998) and ethnic pride (Weisskirch, 2005) but poorer academic outcomes (Umaña-Taylor, 2003) and emotional and behavioral adjustment (Martinez et al., 2009). Increasing language support by providing more speaking opportunities may help empower parents so they rely less on their bilingual young children for translating and navigating complex interactions.

Contrary to our hypothesis, the initial 1-year difference among parents seeking advice and support from their child's teacher was not sustained in the second year, which may be because most children had moved into formal schooling outside of CAP Tulsa by that time. Parents may feel uncomfortable outside of CAP Tulsa and several noted their family's experiences with discrimination in their child's new school environment. Two-generation ESL programs may consider partnering with their local school systems to practice common scenarios between parents and elementary school teachers, which may facilitate more parent-teacher interaction.

The Dual Development of Parents and Children

Although CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program produced some benefits for parents, there were no effects on children. Although these null results were inconsistent with our hypothesis, it was not necessarily surprising given that any effects would need to be above and beyond the known positive impact of CAP Tulsa's

high-quality Head Start program (Gormley et al., 2008; Phillips et al., 2016). For instance, Sommer et al. (2023) examined the 1-year effects of the Two-Generation ESL Program and found that all children, regardless of parent treatment status, performed above or near the average standard score on cognitive assessments. Similarly, a study of a two-generation career training education program also based in CAP Tulsa's Head Start program demonstrated no significant benefits to children's academic, language, and executive functioning skills (Sabol et al., 2024). Additional research is needed to fully understand the effects on children in diverse types of two-generation education programs across different agencies and contexts.

Parents in the treatment group, however, highlighted increased role modeling for children and simultaneous skill development across generations, which offers some initial evidence for the dual developmental science framework. There are limited measurement tools to capture interdependent and bidirectional influences in educational outcomes within family systems. The lack of a dual development measure in this study may also be one reason there were no direct effects of the program on children's skills (Sabol et al., 2021).

Limitations, Future Directions, and Conclusions

This study had several limitations and opportunities for future directions. First, the study asked parents to rate their own English language skills but did not assess proficiency using direct measurement. A multimodal approach pairing direct measures of English skills with subjective ratings would lead to a more nuanced understanding of adult English language learners (De Los Reyes et al., 2017; Pekrun, 2020). This study also benefited from low parent attrition but experienced higher missingness among the child sample. Next, there was a slight mismatch between the quantitative and qualitative results. This illustrates the complexity of the lives of immigrant families as well as the value of conducting mixed-methods research. However, future studies may consider approaches to increase alignment. For example, confidence was a highly discussed topic among parents in the focus groups but only self-esteem was measured in the

survey. In another example, parents in the treatment focus groups reported on the specific practice of role modeling, which was not part of the parenting skills measure on the survey and resulted in null effects across groups. We approached the study with an openness to understanding important processes within families that should be further examined in two-generation ESL programming and research. The outcomes mismatch between data sources is an important finding and serves as an opportunity to improve mixed-methods research going forward. Lastly, future research should study other significant actors within the microsystem of immigrant families in two-generation ESL programs such as English instructors or Head Start teachers.

In summary, the current study provides promising evidence for CAP Tulsa's Two-Generation ESL Program and contributes valuable evidence to the fields of adult ESL, family literacy, and two-generation education programs. This study provided further evidence that contextualizing English pedagogy to adult learners' needs and interests, particularly as immigrant parents, results in improved English proficiency. Paired with existing Head Start services, the Two-Generation ESL Program's positive learning environment and family-based support also appeared to benefit other important outcomes for parents. This holistic approach to serving the needs of immigrant parents, as well as their children and families, may be what is needed to advance adult ESL instruction in the United States. Moreover, the success of this two-generation program has important implications for promoting adult education and family literacy policy as it is relatively inexpensive if anchored in an existing Head Start. The program's cost-effectiveness makes it a viable option to scale and test in diverse contexts such as different geographic locations within the United States or with parents from countries outside of Central and South America and Myanmar. With an innovative family-based approach, two-generation ESL programs have the potential to improve the acculturation process of immigrant families in the United States.

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